MIL-B-44168A
4 May 1988
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-44168
14 May 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BAG, CARRYING; PROTECTIVE ENSEMBLE, NUCLEAR, BIOLOGICAL, CHEMICAL (NBC)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers requirements for the carrying bag (NBC) fabricated from camouflage nylon duck, webbing and tape, with miscellaneous hardware.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203	- Paper, Kraft, Untreated
DDD-L-20	- Label: For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use)
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8465

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MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items, Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

2-3-439 - Bag, Carrying, Nuclear, Biological, Chemical (NBC) Ensemble
2-3-440 - Body

(Copies of drawings, publications, and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Copies should be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Samples of the item, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this document may appear in the sample, in which case this document shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.4).

3.3 Materials and components. Materials (see 6.5) and components shall be as specified on Drawing 2-3-439.

3.4 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the drawings listed in section 2 and as specified herein.

3.4.1 Stitches, seams, and stitchings. All stitching, except bartacking, shall conform to FED-STD-751 as follows:

a. For all stitching except bartacking - Stitch type 301, 10 to 12 stitches per inch.

3.4.1.1 Automatic stitching. Automatic stitching machines may be used to perform any of the required stitch patterns provided the requirements of the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met; and at least three tying, overlapping, or back stitches are used to secure the ends of stitching.

3.4.1.2 Type 301 stitching. Ends of stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1 inch except when caught in other seams and stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be embedded in the materials sewn.

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3.4.1.2.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1 inch back of the end of the stitching.

b. Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch in back of the defective area (1/2 inch on box, box-x and W-W stitching), and continue a minimum of 1 inch beyond the defective area on to the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials and restitching in the required manner.

(When making the above repairs in a. and b. above, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.)

3.4.1.3 Bartacks. Unless otherwise specified, bartacks shall be as specified on the applicable drawing and as follows:

a. Length - 3/4 inch (± 1/16 inch)
b. Width - 1/8 inch (± 1/32 inch)
c. Stitches per bartack - 42

Bartacks shall be free of thread breaks and loose stitching.

3.4.1.4 Thread ends. All thread ends that are visible on the finished item shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/4 inch.

3.4.2 Fusing of ends of nylon tape and webbing. All exposed raw ends of nylon tape and webbing shall be fused. The apparatus used to fuse the tape ends shall be capable of providing sufficient heat to provide a smooth edge with the cut ends of the tape yarns all fused together. Fusing of the webbing and tape ends shall be accomplished prior to being assembled for stitching.

3.4.3 Setting of eyelets. Holes shall be prepunched to receive the eyelets. The holes shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the eyelet barrel so that the barrel must be forced through the hole.

3.4.3.1 Eyelets, with washer, brass. The brass eyelets with washer shall be securely clinched in a manner that will prevent detachment from or cutting of the surrounding material. The eyelets shall be clinched without splitting.

3.5 Marking. The identification marking shall be applied in the location shown on the applicable drawing and shall conform to type IV, class 5 of DDD-L-20.

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3.5.1 Location marks. Location marks shall not be drilled. Printed markings for component location shall not be more than 1/32 inch wide.

3.6 Repairs. Repairs such as mends, darns, patches, or splices are not permitted on the bag.

3.7 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting, and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.3, shall be removed from production and replaced with nondefective and properly matched components.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished and assembled bag shall conform to the quality of product established by this document and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirement in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

* 4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether cut lengths, cut parts, markings for location of components, and location of assembled component parts are in accordance with specified requirements, and that the prepunched holes for receiving eyelets are as specified in 3.4.3. Whenever nonconformance is noted, corrections shall be made to the parts affected and lot in process. Parts which cannot be corrected shall be removed from production.

* 4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 10.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Fabric	Hole, cut, tear, smash, broken or missing yarn, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet)	X	
Tape and webbing	Not firmly and tightly woven; edges frayed or scalloped	X	
	Multiple floats		X
	Any cut, hole, tear, or smash	X	
	Abrasion mark, slub, broken end or pick		X
	Ends not fused as specified (where required)		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Hardware (general)	Broken or malformed failing to serve intended purpose, corroded area, burr, or sharp edge	X	
	Not assembled as specified (unless otherwise classified herein)	X	
	Not specified type, size, or style	X	
	Finish omitted, partially omitted, or not as specified on brass		X
Eyelet	Insecurely clinched or clinched excessively tight, cutting fabric	X	
Open seam	More than 1/2 inch	X	
	1/2 inch or less		X
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches occur.		
Raw edge (on edge required to be finished)	More than 1/2 inch in length when securely caught in stitching	X	
	NOTE: Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as an open seam.		
Run (see open seam)			
Seam and stitch type	Wrong seam or stitch type	X	
Bartacks	One or more bartacks omitted	X	
	Any bartack not as specified or not in specified location		X
	Loose stitching, incomplete, or broken		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in a loose bobbin in top thread		X
	Excessively tight, resulting in puckering of material		X
Stitches per inch	Two or more stitches less than minimum specified	X	
	One stitch less than minimum specified		X
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified		X
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the materials in order to sew over heavy places or heavy seams, or in turning corners shall be classified as follows:		
	a. Within the minor defect classification - no defect		
	b. Within the major defect classification - minor defect		
Thread breaks, skipped or run-off stitches	Not overstitched as specified		X
	NOTE: Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.		
Ends of stitching	Not secured as specified		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Rows of stitching	Any row missing, except on hanger webbing	X	
	On hanger webbing stitch patterns: (applicable to each pattern) -one row of stitching omitted		X
	-two or more rows of stitching omitted	X	
Component and assembly	Any component part omitted or not as specified or any required operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	X	
	Needle chews	X	
	Any mend, darn, patch, or splice	X	
Binding	Loosely applied but not exposing raw edge of material		X
	Loosely applied exposing raw edge of material	X	
Marking	Omitted, illegible, incorrect, or misplaced		X
Location markings	Drilled	X	
	Printed marking more than 1/32 inch in width		X
Cleanness	Any spot or stain clearly noticeable		X
Thread ends	Not trimmed to 1/4 inch maximum length		X

* 4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. Examination shall be made of the bag for conformance to the dimensions annotated with an asterisk on Drawing 2-3-439. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 10.0.

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4.4.5 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete sealing or closure of flap, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number of bundles per shipping container is more or less than required Number of bags per bundle is more or less than required 1/

1/ For this defect one bundle shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

4.4.6 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each bag shall be clean and folded in half to approximate dimensions of 11 by 14 inches. Five bags shall be stacked in alternating directions and secured in a bundle with string or cloth tape.

5.1.2 Commercial. The bags shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. Fifty bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, class weather-resistant, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. The approximate inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be 22 inches in length, 14 inches in width, and 14-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Bundled bags shall be arranged 2 in length, 1 in width, and 5 in depth within the shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

* 5.2.2 Level B packing. Fifty bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, variety DW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. The approximate inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be 22 inches in length, 14 inches in width, and 14-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as guide only. Bundled bags shall be arranged 2 in length, 1 in width, and 5 in depth within the shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

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5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636, and closed in accordance with method III, as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636 except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), bags, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be number 32 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The bag is designed to consolidate and transport the chemical protective ensemble.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.2, 4.3, and 6.4).
c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
e. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Standard sample. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be

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furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.5 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this document (see 3.3).

* 6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Bag, carrying
Chemical protective ensemble
Protective clothing

6.7 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content, as written, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

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Army - MD
Air Force - 82
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Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-44168A	Bag, Carrying; Protective Ensemble, Nuclear, Biological, Chemical (NBC)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK (F), 1 Apr 84

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